

Jaypee University of Information Technology

Department of Computer Science and Engineering and Information Technology

Major Project - I (18B19CI791) | AY 2025-26

End-Term Evaluation | December 12, 2025.

CollabCode Studio: Real-Time Coding & Visual Collaboration Platform.

Group No. : 80

Team Member (s)

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Supervisor

- Name: Ms. Nitika
Designation: Assistant Professor

- Introduction
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- Modern software development is highly collaborative but relies on a **disconnected toolchain** (e.g., VS Code + Slack + Miro).
- This fragmentation leads to several key issues:
 - **Reduced Productivity:** Constant context-switching between applications breaks developers' focus and "flow state."
 - **Communication Gaps:** Project discussions and decisions are scattered across different platforms, making it hard to track context.
 - **Onboarding Hurdles for Learners:** New developers face a steep learning curve in setting up complex local development environments.
- There is a clear need for a unified platform that centralizes these activities, reduces friction, and provides an accessible environment for both professionals and learners.

- **To Develop a Unified Collaborative Platform:** Design and build an integrated web application featuring a real-time code editor, chat, and visual drawing board.
- **To Ensure Real-Time Synchronization:** Implement a robust, low-latency synchronization mechanism using WebSockets and CRDTs to provide a seamless multi-user experience.
- **To Integrate AI-Powered Assistance:** Incorporate an AI assistant to provide intelligent code suggestions and error detection, enhancing developer productivity.
- **To Create an Accessible Learning Tool:** Offer a zero-setup, browser-based environment to lower the barrier to entry for students and aspiring developers.
- **To Deploy a Scalable Cloud-Native Application:** Containerize the application using Docker and deploy it on a scalable cloud infrastructure like AWS EC2 to ensure high availability and performance.

Literature Review (cont...)

S. No.	Author & Paper Title [Citation]	Journal/ Conference (Year)	Tools/ Techniques/ Dataset	Key Findings/ Results	Limitations/ Gaps Identified
5.	R. Ferdiana, "The Impact of Artificial Intelligence on Programmer Productivity" [5]	Conference Paper, 2024	Artificial Intelligence (AI)	Highlights the positive impact of AI on programming tasks and enhancing developer productivity.	Conceptual Paper, Lacks Empirical Data to validate it's impact.
6.	A. Gote, "Real-time Interactivity in Hybrid Applications With Web Sockets" [6]	International Research Journal of Modernization in Engineering Technology and Science (IRJMETS), 2024	WebSockets	Confirms that WebSockets provide the persistent, low-latency, bidirectional communication channel necessary for a seamless collaborative experience.	It does not introduce a new protocol or provide a quantitative performance comparison against other real-time technologies like long-polling.
7.	M. C. da Silva, et al., "A Visual Tool for Supporting Collaborative Code Quality" [7]	23rd International Conference on Computer Supported Cooperative Work in Design (CSCWD), 2019	Visual Tools for Code Quality	Addresses the need for visual tools to support collaborative coding, which is a core feature of the project.	Does not include a large-scale empirical study with industry developers to quantitatively measure its impact on productivity or code quality.
8.	M. B. Khan, et al., "Design and Development of Real-time Code Editor for Collaborative Programming" [8]	International Journal of Scientific Research in Computer Science and Engineering, vol. 11, no. 6, pp. 19-26, Dec. 2023	Real-time Code Editors	Reinforces the importance of WebSockets for a seamless collaborative experience in real-time code editors.	Does not provide a comparative analysis of other key synchronization methods like CRDTs or Operational Transformation (OT)

Literature Review (cont...)

S. No.	Author & Paper Title [Citation]	Journal/ Conference (Year)	Tools/ Techniques/ Dataset	Key Findings/ Results	Limitations/ Gaps Identified
13.	M. Kotsovoulou and V. Stefanou, "Student Perceptions on the Effectiveness of Collaborative Problem-based Learning Using Online Pair Programming Tools" [13]	WSEAS Transactions on Proof, vol. 1, pp. 15-22, 2021	Online Pair Programming Tools	A qualitative study that found students perceive these tools as highly effective for problem-solving, increasing participation, and enhancing engagement and knowledge sharing.	This is a qualitative study focused on student perceptions and does not provide quantitative data.
14.	J. Fiala, M. Yee-King, and M. Grierson, "Collaborative coding interfaces on the Web" [14]	International Conference on Live Coding (ICLI), 2016	Web-based Collaborative Coding	It explores the design and implementation of collaborative coding interfaces on the web, relevant to the project's core functionality.	Collaboration is primarily text-based (editor); lacks explicit integration of a shared visual brainstorming canvas or integrated AI features.
15.	S. W. Lee, et al., Communication, Control, and State Sharing in Networked Collaborative Live Coding (UrMus)" [15]	ACM Computing Surveys (CSUR), vol. 54, no. 1, pp. 1-38, 2021	Real-time Collaborative Editing Systems	Provides a comprehensive overview of the field, which is foundational to the project.	Focuses on Live Music/Audio coding (Lua/UrMus); the solutions are not generalized to the broader general software development or visual collaboration needs.

Work Done (after Mid-Term Evaluation)

October 2025 (System Design Finalization)

- Finalize the detailed System Architecture, Component Diagrams, and Sequence Diagrams.
- Review libraries, tools & frameworks and decide possible approach.

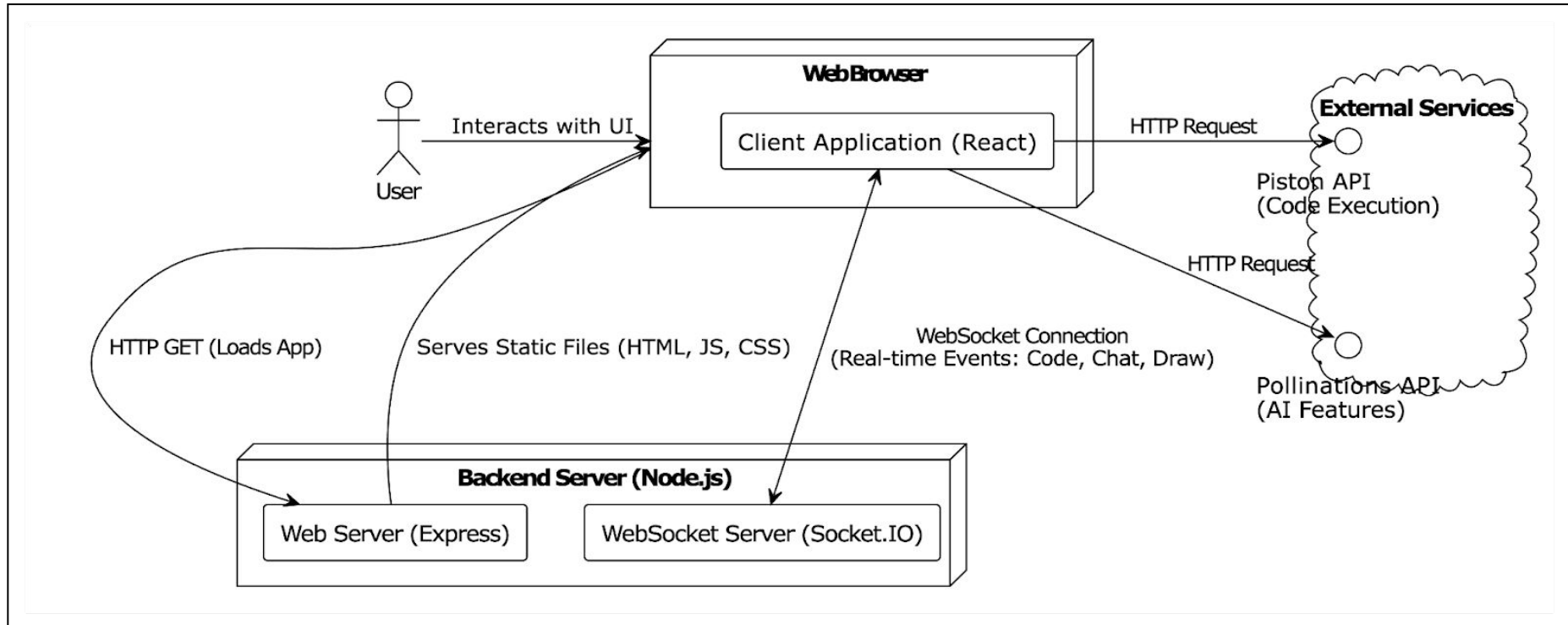
November 2025 (Feature Development)

- Implement the basic frontend structure with ReactJS, including routing and main views.
- Implement the Real-Time Chat functionality..
- Start working on Real-Time Collaborative Editor synchronization.

December 2025 (Integration, Testing & Evaluation Preparation)

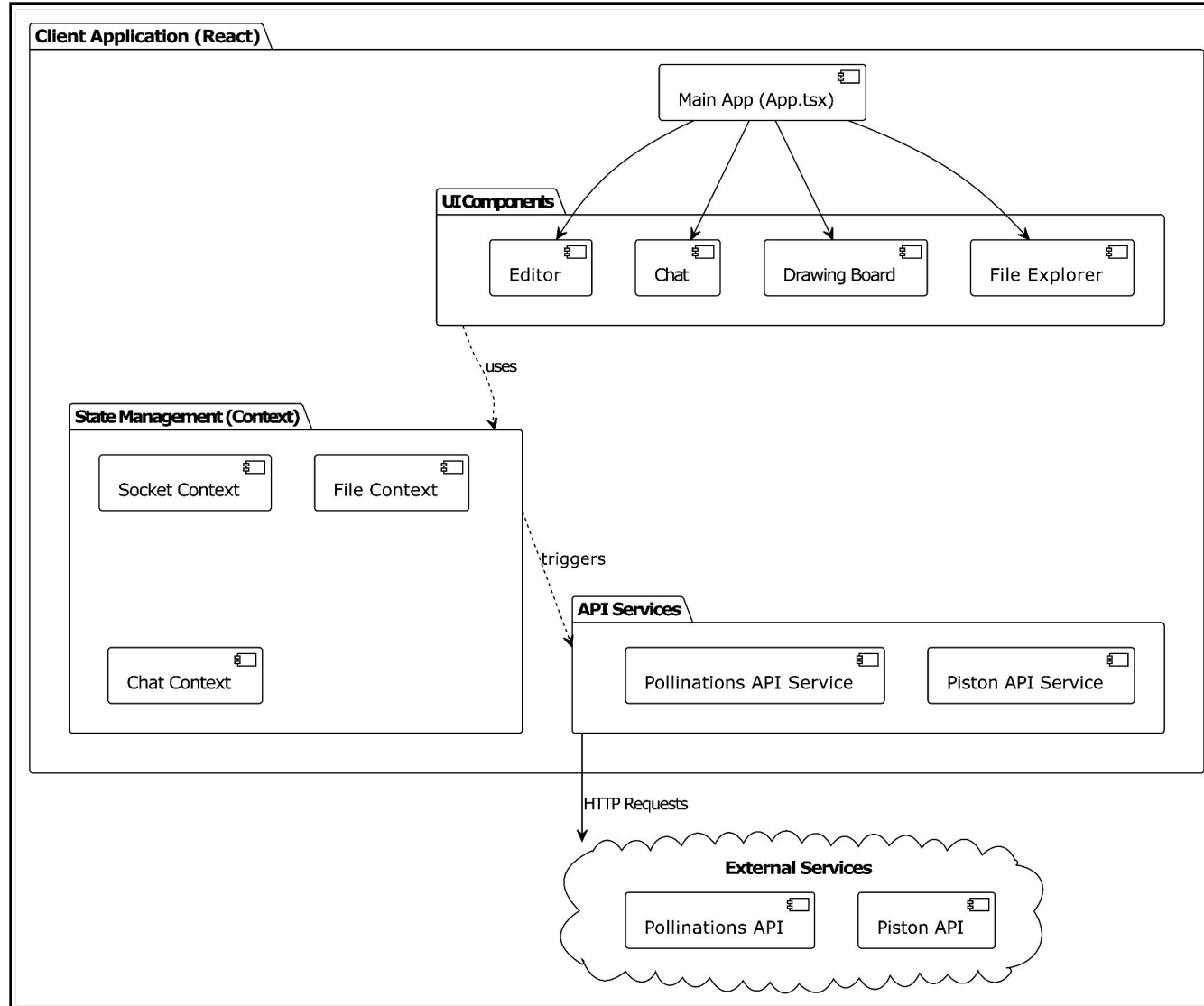
- Integrating and Testing the MVP features like (editor & chat).
- Prepare documentation, project presentation & demo for evaluation.

- High Level System Architecture

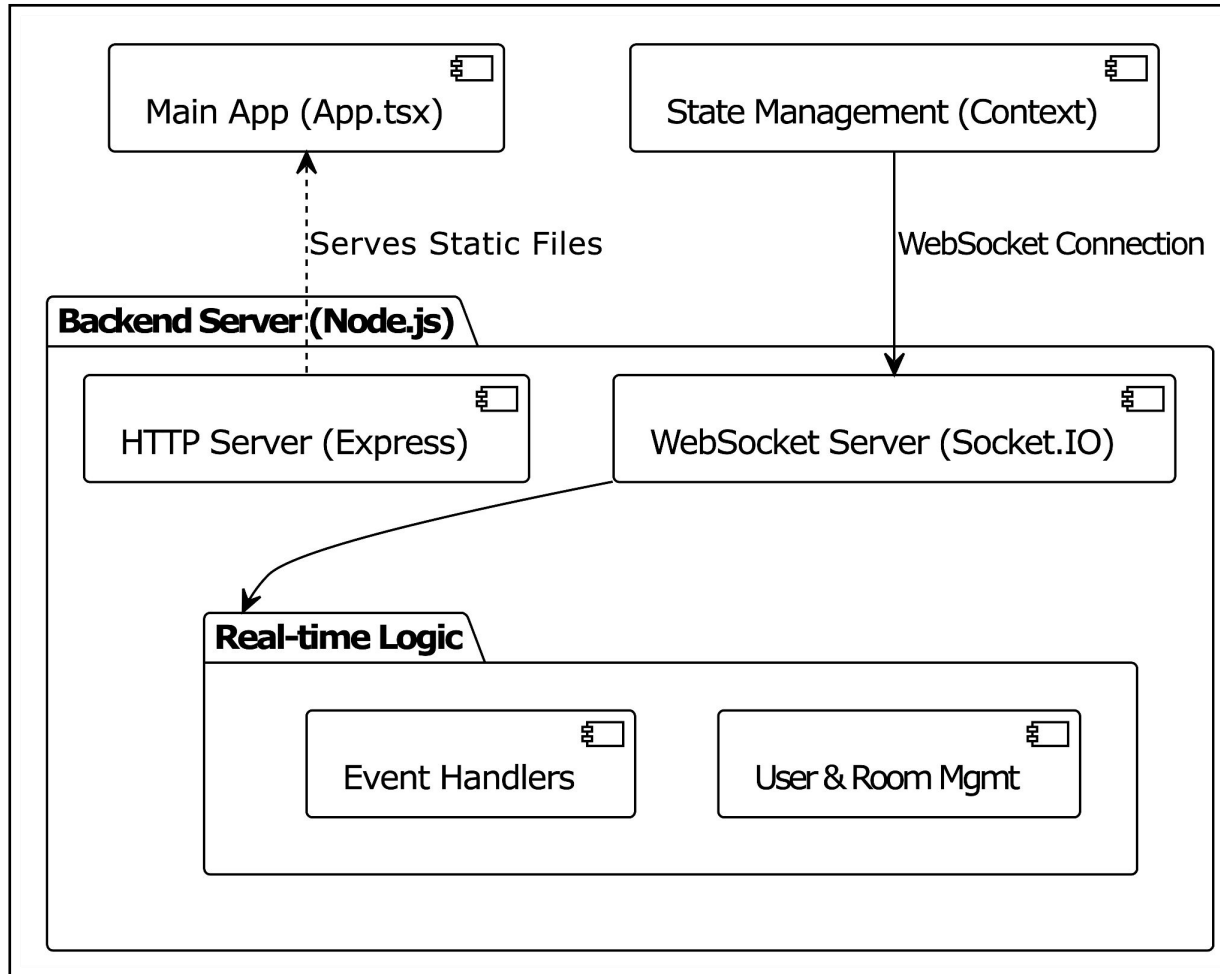


Shows the **overall interaction** between the Client Application, the Backend Server, and External Services. It highlights how the client communicates with the backend via WebSockets and HTTP while also making direct API calls to third-party services.

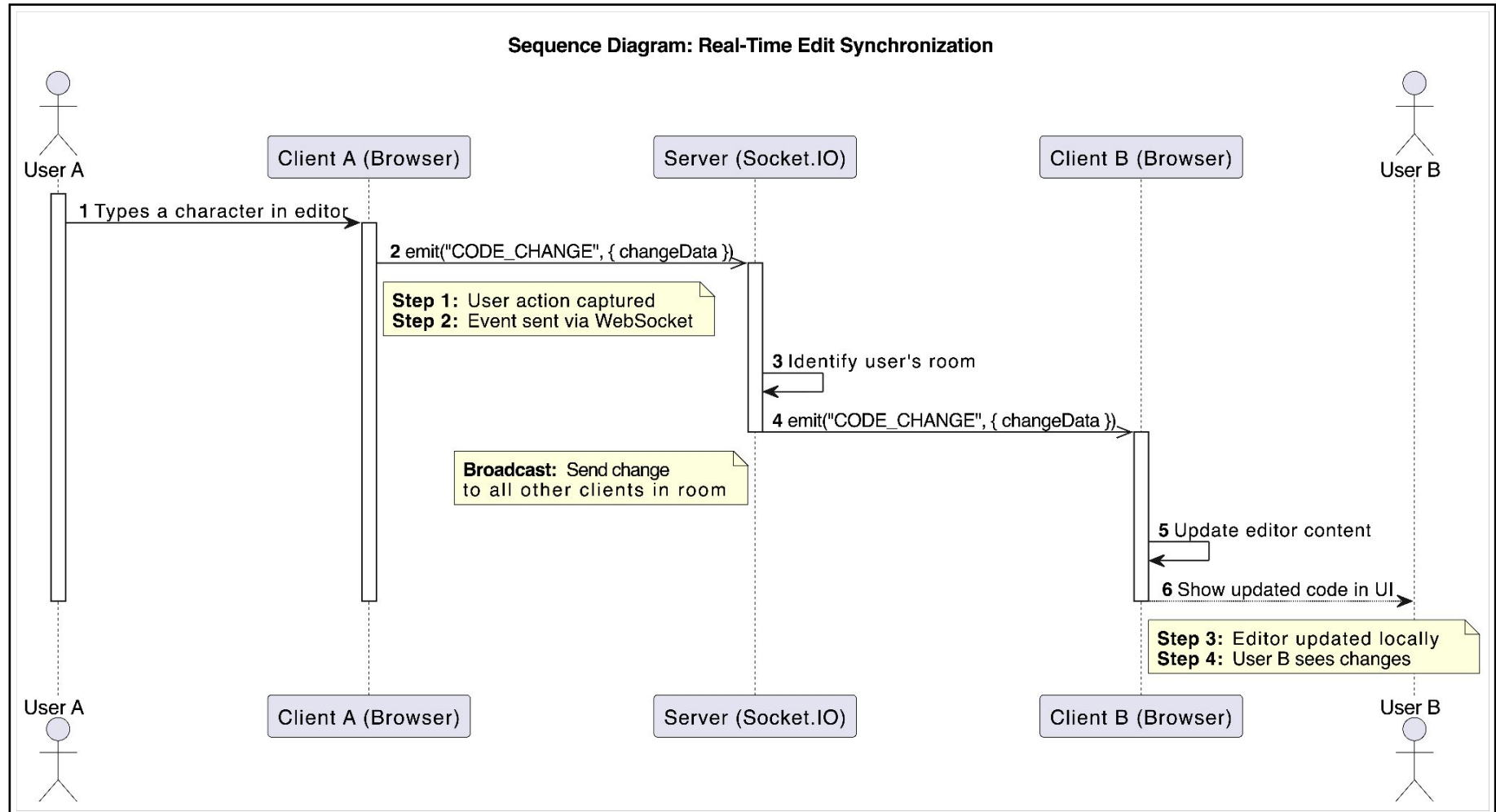
- Client Application Diagram



- Backend Server Diagram



- Sequence Diagram – Real-Time Edit Synchronisation



Backend Development

- **Node.js (v20.x LTS):** The JavaScript runtime environment for the server.
- **Express.js (v4.x):** A minimal web application framework for building the REST API.
- **Socket.IO (v4.x):** The core library for enabling real-time, bidirectional WebSocket communication.

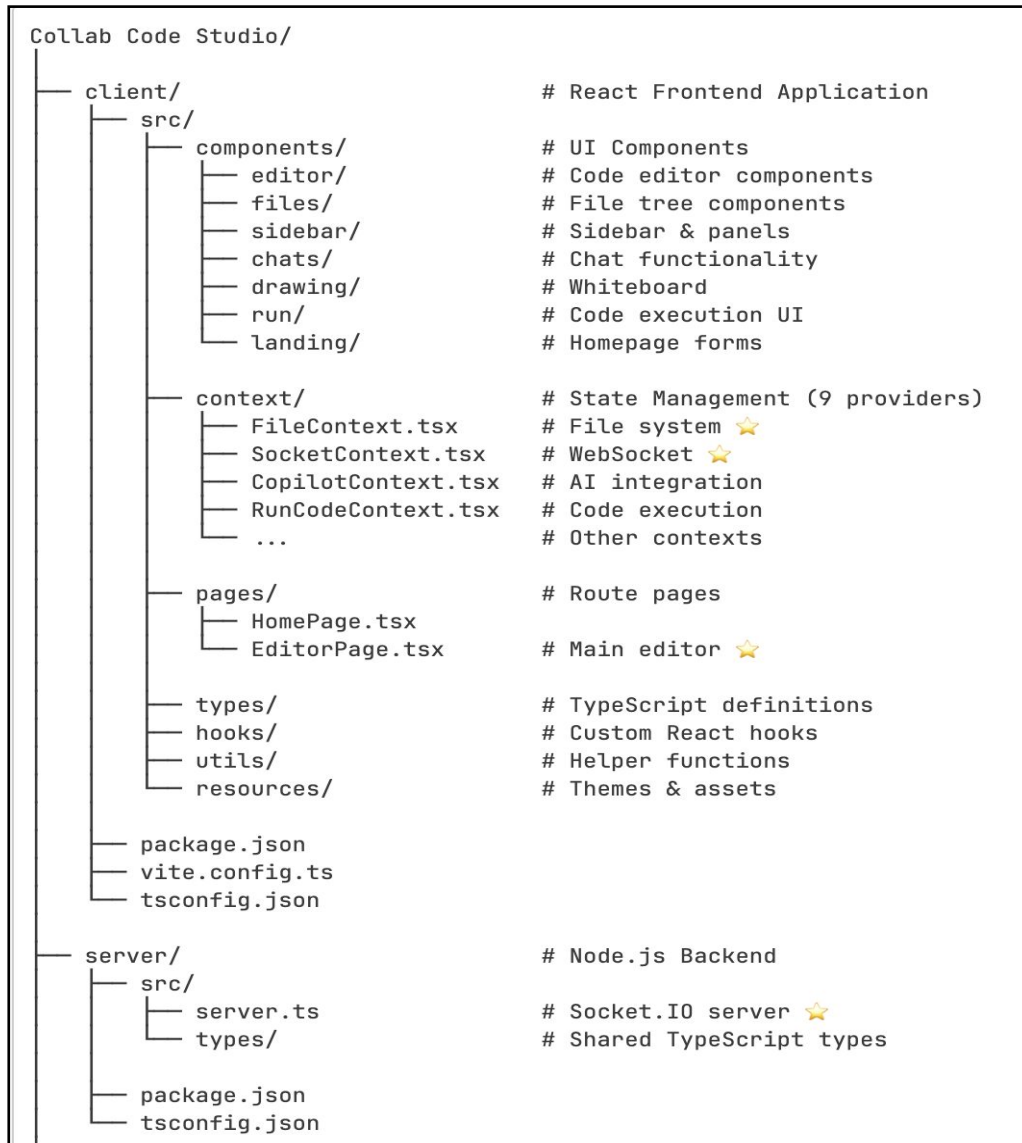
Deployment & DevOps

- **Docker (v24.x):** Used for containerizing the application to ensure a consistent and isolated environment.
- **AWS EC2:** The cloud platform for deploying and hosting the scalable backend server.

General Tools

- **Git & GitHub:** For version control and collaborative code management.

- **Project Directory Structure**



- **Server Initialization & Configuration**

```
const app = express();
app.use(express.json());
app.use(cors());
app.use(express.static(path.join(__dirname, "public")));

const server = http.createServer(app);
const io = new Server(server, {
  cors: {
    origin: "*", // Allow all origins for collaboration
  },
  maxHttpBufferSize: 1e8, // 100MB buffer for large file transfers
  pingTimeout: 60000,      // 60s timeout to handle slow connections
});

let userSocketMap: User[] = []; // Global state for active users
```

- **Realtime File Synchronisation**

```
// When user joins, sync complete file structure
const handleUserJoined = useCallback(({ user }: { user: RemoteUser }) => {
  toast.success(`${user.username} joined`)

  // Send complete state to new user's socket
  socket.emit(SocketEvent.SYNC_FILE_STRUCTURE, {
    fileStructure, // Entire directory tree
    openFiles,    // Currently open files
    activeFile,   // Active editor file
    socketId: user.socketId // Target specific user
  })

  setUsers((prev) => [...prev, user])
}, [fileStructure, openFiles, activeFile, socket])
```

- Tooltip for real time cursor

```
// CodeMirror StateField for real-time cursor awareness
export const tooltipField = (users: User[]) => {
  return StateField.define<readonly Tooltip[]>({
    create: getCursorTooltips(users),

    update(tooltips, tr) {
      if (!tr.docChanged && !tr.selection) return tooltips
      return getCursorTooltips(users)(tr.state)
    },

    provide: (f) => showTooltip.computeN([f], (state) =>
      state.field(f)
    ),
  })
}

function getCursorTooltips(users: User[]) {
  return (state: EditorState): readonly Tooltip[] => {
    return users.filter(u => u.typing).map(user => ({
      pos: user.cursorPosition,
      above: true,
      create: () => {
        const dom = document.createElement("div")
        dom.className = "cm-cursor-tooltip"
        dom.textContent = user.username
        return { dom }
      }
    }))
  }
}
```

- Websockets Event Handler

```
// Server-side collaboration logic
io.on("connection", (socket) => {

  // User joins room
  socket.on(SocketEvent.JOIN_REQUEST, ({ roomId, username }) => {
    // Check duplicate username
    const isUsernameExist = getUsersInRoom(roomId)
      .filter(u => u.username === username)

    if (isUsernameExist.length > 0) {
      socket.emit(SocketEvent.USERNAME_EXISTS)
      return
    }

    // Create user session
    const user = { username, roomId, socketId: socket.id,
      cursorPosition: 0, typing: false }
    userSocketMap.push(user)
    socket.join(roomId)

    // Broadcast to room
    socket.broadcast.to(roomId)
      .emit(SocketEvent.USER_JOINED, { user })

    // Send existing users to new joiner
    socket.emit(SocketEvent.JOIN_ACCEPTED, {
      user,
      users: getUsersInRoom(roomId)
    })
  })

  // File operations broadcast
  socket.on(SocketEvent.FILE_UPDATED, ({ fileId, newContent }) => {
    const roomId = getRoomId(socket.id)
    socket.broadcast.to(roomId)
      .emit(SocketEvent.FILE_UPDATED, { fileId, newContent })
  })
})
```

- Room Creation & Joining Page

CollabCode Studio

Real-time collaborative coding with AI assistance.
Write, share, and ship code faster than ever.

Join a Room

Enter your details to start collaborating

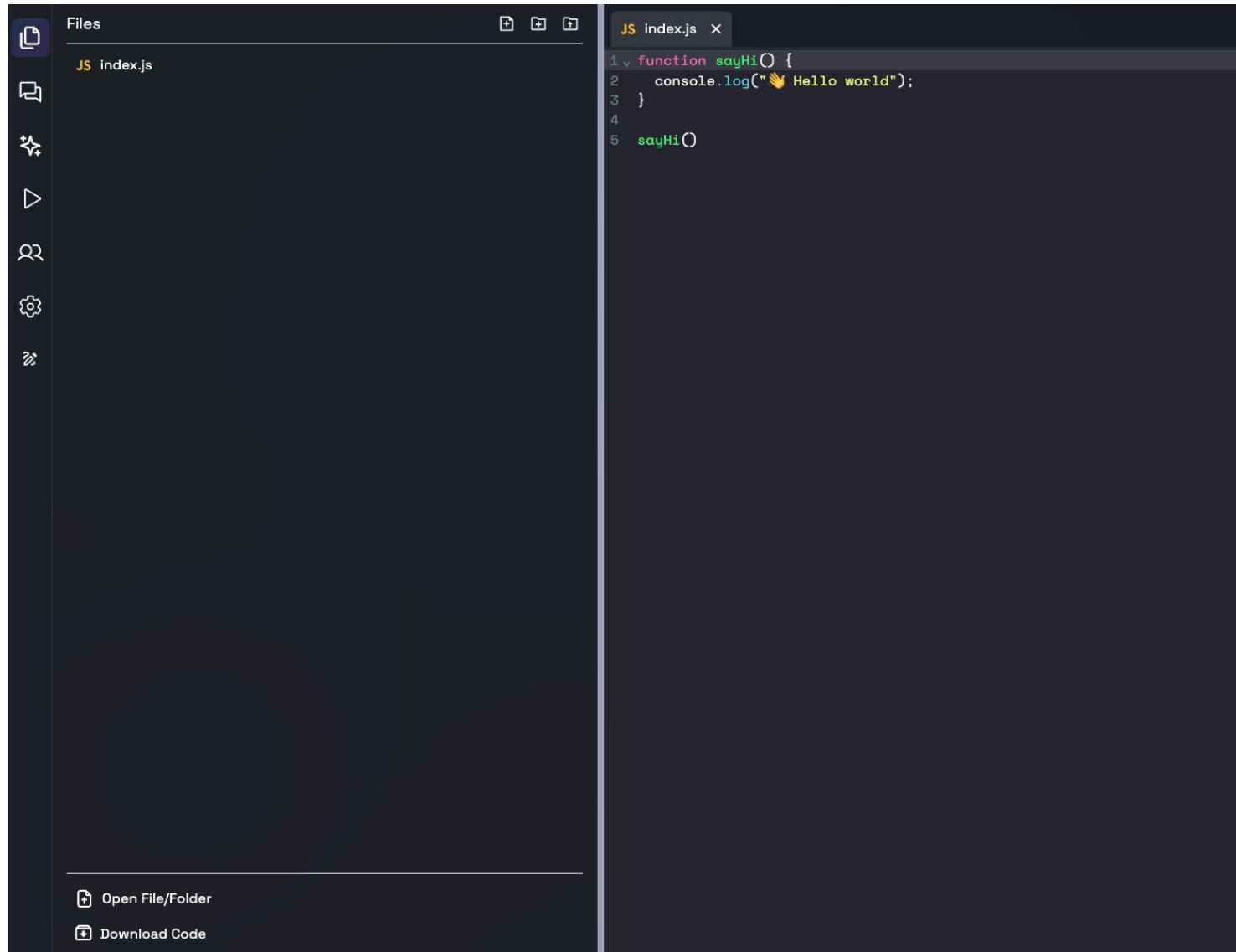
Join Room

[Generate Unique Room ID](#)



Implementation

- Editor Layout



- **Functional Completion**

1. **Real-Time Collaborative Editor**

- a. Many people can edit the same file at the same time.
- b. Socket.IO keeps edits in sync in real time with no inconsistency.
- c. All connected users receive reflections of cursor positions and typing indicators.

2. **Project Structure Synchronization**

- a. It sends the entire file and folder structure to any new user who joins a session.
- b. Conflicts of duplicate file names are resolved automatically.

3. **Integrated Live Chat**

- a. Seamless conversation in a room, with no third-party apps necessary.

4. **Interactive Whiteboard**

- a. Multi-user real-time drawing with stroke-level synchronization.
- b. Smooth loading of the existing canvas state when new users join.

5. **AI Powered Features**

- a. Snippets are generated and code recommended through API calls.

Experimental Results and Evaluation (cont...)

- Comparison with Existing Solutions**

Feature/Criteria	VS Code Live Share	Replit Multiplayer	Google Colab	CollabCode Studio
Real-Time Code Editing	Yes	Yes	Limited	Yes(via Socket.IO)
Built-in Chat	No	Limited	Yes	Yes
Shared Visual Board	No	No	No	Yes (Real-Time, Multi-user)
AI Code Suggestion	Yes(via extension)	Yes	Yes	Yes (Integrated)
Multi-Language Support	Yes	Yes	Python Only	Yes (via Piston API)
File Structure Sync	Limited	Yes	No	Yes
Setup Effort	High (requires VS Code)	Medium	Low	Very Low (Browser-based)
One-Stop Collaboration	Partial	Partial	Partial	Fully Unified Workspace

Learning Outcome: Gained a deep, practical understanding of full-stack web development and the complexities of building real-time, distributed systems from the ground up.

Methodology Followed:

- **Literature Survey:** Studied foundational research papers on CRDTs, WebSockets, and AI in software engineering to inform our technical decisions.

Tools Learned:

- **Frontend:** ReactJS, Vite, Tailwind CSS
- **Backend:** Node.js, Express.js
- **Real-Time Communication:** Socket.IO
- **Deployment:** Docker, AWS EC2

Work Contribution and Attendance

GitHub Repository URL: <https://github.com/divyanshuchander/CollabCode-MajorProject.git>

Team Member	Roll No.	Work Done (provide complete details)	Work Contribution (%)	Lines of Code (if any)	Lab Attendance (%)
1.	221030460	• Preparation of project proposal. • Maintained the git repository • Ideated the project's system architecture design. • Created system architecture flowcharts. • Prepared initial draft of project report. • Worked on presentation • Implemented the Initial Project MVP	35%	~1500	100%
2.	221030423	• Ideated the project's system architecture design. • Prepared initial draft of project report. • Worked on end-term presentation.	15%	-	100%
3.	221031057	• Prepared initial draft of project report. • Worked on end-term presentation, • Literature review of research papers • Designed the Frontend UI and integrated the Code Editor. • Designed a modular component-based architecture to ensure the frontend is scalable and easy to maintain. • Diary Management	35%	~600	100%
4.	221030296	• Worked on end-term presentation, • Literature review of research papers • Diary Management	15%	-	100%

Supervisor Interactions (as mentioned in weekly log)

No. of Meetings with Supervisor:

Week No.	Duration	Remarks (as mentioned in the weekly log)	Incorporated (Yes/No)
1.	25/08/2025 to 01/09/2025	- Improvements in proposal - Suggestions on the project and its approach.	Yes
2.	15/09/2025 to 22/09/2025	- Read recent papers. - Improve format of literature survey.	Yes
3.	22/09/2025 to 29/09/2025	- Improve formatting of initial project report draft. - Corrections in the Mid-Term Evaluation presentation.	Yes
4.	3/10/2025 to 9/10/2025	- Approved the system architecture. - Start the implementation of the core modules.	Yes
5.	25/10/2025 to 31/10/2025	- Demonstrate the initial prototype. - Focus on improving the User Interface (UI).	Yes

Supervisor Interactions (as mentioned in weekly log)

No. of Meetings with Supervisor:

Week No.	Duration	Remarks (as mentioned in the weekly log)	Incorporated (Yes/No)
6.	1/11/2025 to 7/11/2025	• Ensure proper error handling in the code. • Update the weekly progress log regularly.	Yes
7.	10/11/2025 to 15/11/2025	• Start testing the application for bugs. • Document the test cases and results.	Yes
8.	17/11/2025 to 22/11/2025	• Work on the Final Report formatting.	Yes
9.	24/11/2025 to 29/11/2025	• Correction in the Formatting of the report • Prepare for the final presentation.	Yes
10.	24/11/2025 to 29/11/2025	• Project work satisfactory. • Submit the final report and code.	Yes

Project Plan

Activity	Year 2025										Year 2026									
	Aug.		Sept.		Oct.		Nov.		Dec.		Jan.		Feb.		Mar.		Apr.		May	
Literature Review																				
Analysis and Requirements																				
Project Design and Architecture																				
Implementation																				
Testing and Validation																				
Documentation and Write-up																				

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